

D586

Public Health Policy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A state legislature, which meets only 90 days a year, passes a law requiring lead testing of drinking water in child care centers. The state health department then writes detailed rules on testing frequency and allowable levels. What are the department's rules?

- A. Regulations.
- B. Legislation.
- C. Advisory guidance, since only legislatures can make binding rules.
- D. Organizational policy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hospital system requires all of its employees to receive a flu vaccine each year as a condition of employment. What type of policy is this?

- A. A public health law binding on all residents.
- B. State regulation.
- C. Organizational policy.
- D. Legislation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

For years, advocates in a state that recently built a new football stadium failed to pass a sugary-drink tax. Then a widely reported study showed childhood obesity had doubled, a bill was already drafted, and a new governor who campaigned on child health took office. The tax passed that session. What best explains why?

- A. The problem, policy, and politics streams converged, opening a policy window.
- B. The new study alone persuaded legislators.
- C. Stadium revenue needs made a new tax necessary.
- D. Policies always pass once enough data exist.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A city council has passed a smoke-free parks ordinance. The parks department, which has 40 employees, now posts signs, trains rangers, and issues warnings to violators. Which stage of the policy cycle is this?

- A. Evaluation.
- B. Adoption.
- C. Agenda setting.
- D. Implementation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A year after a smoke-free parks ordinance took effect, analysts compare cigarette litter counts before and after to advise whether to keep it. Which stage of the policy cycle is this?

- A. Agenda setting.
- B. Formulation.
- C. Evaluation.
- D. Implementation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

During a measles outbreak in a school district that recently opened a new STEM magnet school, the health department excludes unvaccinated exposed students from school for 21 days. Some parents say this violates their liberty. Which principle best supports the department's action?

- A. States may use police power for necessary, proportionate, time-limited measures that are the least restrictive effective option.
- B. Health departments may exclude any student for as long as they choose.
- C. Only the federal government may restrict school attendance.
- D. Individual liberty always outweighs public health measures.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A mid-size city that recently won a national arts grant wants to reduce childhood asthma. Its health department joins the transportation, housing, and planning departments to weigh health effects in bus routes, housing codes, and zoning. What approach is this?

- A. Expanding clinical asthma care.
- B. Health in All Policies.
- C. An arts-based health campaign.
- D. Social marketing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 501(c)(3) health coalition with 12 staff publishes a nonpartisan report on the health effects of e-cigarettes and shares it with the public and with legislators, without urging a vote on any bill. How is this activity classified?

- A. Illegal, because the coalition has paid staff.
- B. Political campaign activity.
- C. Education and advocacy, not lobbying.
- D. Lobbying, which 501(c)(3)s are banned from entirely.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The same coalition emails its members urging them to call their state senators and vote yes on a specific e-cigarette tax bill. How is this classified?

- A. Prohibited political campaign activity.
- B. Grassroots lobbying, allowed for a 501(c)(3) only within limits.
- C. Unlimited, because it concerns health.
- D. Nonpartisan education.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A state, which recently renovated its capitol building, raises cigarette taxes enough to lift the average pack price by 20%. The price elasticity of demand for cigarettes is -0.4 . What change in consumption should analysts expect?

- A. About a 50% decrease.
- B. About an 8% increase.
- C. About a 20% decrease.
- D. About an 8% decrease.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Analysts want a 6% drop in youth cigarette use. Youth price elasticity is -0.6 . About what price increase is needed?

- A. 6%
- B. 0.6%
- C. 3.6%
- D. 10%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A country that recently hosted a major international sports event ratifies the WHO Framework Convention on Tobacco Control. Which statement best describes how the treaty's measures take effect there?

- A. WHO inspectors enforce tobacco bans inside the country.
- B. WHO provides the framework and support; the country must adopt and enforce its own laws.
- C. WHO fines the country if smoking rates do not fall.
- D. Ratification makes national tobacco laws unnecessary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A state legislature, ~~which meets only 90 days a year,~~ passes a law requiring lead testing of drinking water in child care centers. The state health department then writes detailed rules on testing frequency and allowable levels. What are the department's rules?

Target word: type of policy **Decides:** An agency wrote binding rules to implement a law.

A	Correct	Agency rules that implement a statute are regulations.
B	Adjacent category	Only the legislature's act is legislation.
C	Absolute language	Regulations issued under legal authority are binding.
D	Confusion set	Organizational policy binds only an organization's own members.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A hospital system requires all of its employees to receive a flu vaccine each year as a condition of employment. What type of policy is this?

Target word: type of policy **Decides:** An organization binding its own members.

A	Dropped element	Ignores that it applies only to employees.
B	Adjacent category	No agency rulemaking is involved.
C	Correct	Set by an employer and applies only to its workforce.
D	Confusion set	No legislature passed it.

3. Answer A Concept 2

For years, advocates in a state ~~that recently built a new football stadium~~ failed to pass a sugary-drink tax. Then a widely reported study showed childhood obesity had doubled, a bill was already drafted, and a new governor who campaigned on child health took office. The tax passed that session. What best explains why?

Target word: why policy passed now **Decides:** Problem, solution, and politics lined up.

A	Correct	All three streams aligned at once.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the ready bill and the political shift.
C	Camouflage	Nothing links the stadium to this tax.
D	Absolute language	Data had existed before; politics and a ready solution also matter.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A city council has passed a smoke-free parks ordinance. The parks department, ~~which has 40 employees,~~ now posts signs, trains rangers, and issues warnings to violators. Which stage of the policy cycle is this?

Target word: policy stage **Decides:** Putting an adopted policy into practice.

A	Confusion set	Evaluation judges whether it worked.
B	Adjacent category	Adoption was the council's vote, already done.
C	Inverted operation	The first stage, when the problem gains attention.
D	Correct	Carrying out and enforcing an adopted policy is implementation.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A year after a smoke-free parks ordinance took effect, analysts compare cigarette litter counts before and after to advise whether to keep it. Which stage of the policy cycle is this?

Target word: policy stage **Decides:** Judging results to inform the next decision.

A	Inverted operation	Evaluation may feed the agenda, but this activity is measuring results.
B	Confusion set	Formulation drafts policy options.
C	Correct	Measuring effects to inform continuation is evaluation.
D	Adjacent category	Implementation is carrying the policy out.

6. Answer A Concept 4

During a measles outbreak in a school district ~~that recently opened a new STEM magnet school~~, the health department excludes unvaccinated exposed students from school for 21 days. Some parents say this violates their liberty. Which principle best supports the department's action?

Target word: legal and ethical basis **Decides:** A necessary, time-limited, proportionate measure.

A	Correct	A 21-day exclusion tied to the incubation period meets these tests.
B	Dropped element	Drops the limits of necessity, proportionality, and time.
C	Confusion set	School and disease control authority rests mainly with states.
D	Absolute language	Courts have long upheld reasonable public health restrictions.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A mid-size city ~~that recently won a national arts grant~~ wants to reduce childhood asthma. Its health department joins the transportation, housing, and planning departments to weigh health effects in bus routes, housing codes, and zoning. What approach is this?

Target word: name the approach **Decides:** Health built into non-health sectors' decisions.

A	Confusion set	A medical response, not cross-sector policy.
B	Correct	Cross-sector decision-making with health in view.
C	Camouflage	The arts grant is unrelated to the approach.
D	Adjacent category	Social marketing promotes behaviors to individuals.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A 501(c)(3) health coalition ~~with 12 staff~~ publishes a nonpartisan report on the health effects of e-cigarettes and shares it with the public and with legislators, without urging a vote on any bill. How is this activity classified?

Target word: classify the activity **Decides:** No call to action on specific legislation.

A	Camouflage	Staff size does not decide the classification.
B	Confusion set	No candidate is supported or opposed.
C	Correct	Nonpartisan analysis without a call to act on a bill is not lobbying.
D	Absolute language	It is not lobbying, and 501(c)(3)s may lobby within limits.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

The same coalition emails its members urging them to call their state senators and vote yes on a specific e-cigarette tax bill. How is this classified?

Target word: classify the activity **Decides:** A call to action on a specific bill.

A	Confusion set	Campaign activity involves candidates, not bills.
B	Correct	Urging the public to contact legislators about a specific bill is lobbying.
C	Adjacent category	The topic does not remove lobbying limits.
D	Inverted operation	A call to act on a bill turns education into lobbying.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A state, ~~which recently renovated its capitol building,~~ raises cigarette taxes enough to lift the average pack price by 20%. The price elasticity of demand for cigarettes is -0.4 . What change in consumption should analysts expect?

Target word: expected consumption change **Decides:** $-0.4 \times 20\%$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides 20% by 0.4 instead of multiplying.
B	Confusion set	Negative elasticity means consumption falls as price rises.
C	Dropped element	Ignores elasticity; assumes a one-to-one drop.
D	Correct	$-0.4 \times 20\% = -8\%$.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

Analysts want a 6% drop in youth cigarette use. Youth price elasticity is -0.6 . About what price increase is needed?

Target word: solve for price change **Decides:** Price change = $-6\% \div -0.6$.

A	Dropped element	Assumes a one-to-one response.
B	Wrong stem number	The elasticity, not a price change.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies 6% by 0.6 instead of dividing.
D	Correct	$6\% / 0.6 = 10\%$.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A country ~~that recently hosted a major international sports event~~ ratifies the WHO Framework Convention on Tobacco Control. Which statement best describes how the treaty's measures take effect there?

Target word: WHO's role vs. the state's **Decides:** WHO sets norms; countries enforce.

A	Inverted operation	WHO has no enforcement staff inside countries.
B	Correct	Treaty obligations are carried out through national law.
C	Adjacent category	WHO has no fining power.
D	Absolute language	National laws are how the treaty is implemented.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Types of policy	Legislatures pass laws; agencies write regulations to carry them out; organizations set internal policies that bind only their own members.	Calling agency rules legislation, or an employer rule a public law.	Who wrote the rule and whom it binds.
2	Multiple streams and policy windows	Policy change is most likely when a recognized problem, a ready solution, and favorable politics converge, opening a window.	Believing good data alone passes policy.	A long-stalled idea suddenly passes after several things change.
3	The policy cycle	Agenda setting → formulation → adoption → implementation → evaluation, then back to the agenda.	Calling enforcement adoption, or review implementation.	What is happening now to an already-passed or proposed policy.
4	Police power and individual liberty	Government may limit personal liberty to protect public health when the measure is necessary, proportionate, time-limited, and the least restrictive effective option.	Believing liberty always wins, or that any restriction is justified indefinitely.	A restriction challenged as a violation of rights.
5	Health in All Policies	Because transportation, housing, education, and planning shape health, HiAP builds health into decisions across all sectors.	Treating health as the health department's job alone.	Several non-health agencies working together on a health outcome.
6	Education vs. lobbying for nonprofits	Nonpartisan analysis and education are not lobbying; urging a vote on specific legislation is lobbying, which 501(c)(3)s may do only within limits; they may not campaign for candidates.	Believing charities can never lobby, or that sharing research counts as lobbying.	Whether the message asks for action on a specific bill.
7	Taxes and price elasticity	$\% \text{ change in consumption} \approx \text{elasticity} \times \% \text{ change in price}$; to reach a target drop, $\text{price change} = \text{target} \div \text{elasticity}$.	Assuming a one-to-one drop, or dividing when you should multiply.	A tax-driven price change and an elasticity figure.
8	Global health governance	WHO sets norms, coordinates, and hosts treaties such as the tobacco framework convention; member states implement and enforce through their own laws.	Believing WHO directly enforces or fines countries.	A global treaty or WHO action and a question about who enforces it.

Course scope (public description): Public Health Policy introduces students to laws, regulations, actions, and decisions implemented within society to promote wellness and ensure specific health goals are met. Public health policies range from formal legislation to community outreach efforts. In this course, learners will examine the role of public health, the impact it has on our society, and strategies to promote health and health policy on a community and global level.